

5

LAB VALUES EVERY NIGERIAN SHOULD *UNDERSTAND*



A Simple Guide to Taking Charge of Your Health



Managing your health starts with understanding what's happening inside your body. Often, we walk out of a clinic with a sheet of paper full of acronyms and numbers, feeling completely in the dark.

This guide breaks down [five essential lab tests](#) every Nigerian should know about. It is designed to help you understand what your results mean and prepare you for meaningful conversations with your doctor.

That is exactly why we are building [Clinsight](#). We believe you shouldn't need a medical degree to understand your own body. [Clinsight](#) is an app that will let you upload your lab results, get instant clear interpretations, and automatically log personalized follow-up questions so you know exactly what to ask your doctor at your next visit.

Please Note: While our app is still in development, this guide is your first step toward better health. By downloading this guide, you are on our exclusive waitlist, and we will notify you the very moment [Clinsight goes live!](#)

IMPORTANT NOTE ON "NORMAL" RANGES

Before we dive in, let's clear up an important fact: medical science does have standard, universally accepted baseline ranges for a healthy human body. However, individual laboratories fine-tune these on their result sheets. A "normal" number at a lab in Lagos might look a tiny bit different from a "normal" number at a lab in Abuja or Ibadan depending on the specific chemical kits and machines they use.

Crucially, these variations are minor, [usually a slight difference of just 1 or 2 \\$mg/dL\\$ or \\$mmol/L\\$](#). It is never a glaring, massive jump like 20 units off. Because your exact baseline is tied to the specific equipment used, you should always check the "reference range" column printed directly on your specific result sheet. For this reason, this guide focuses on the big picture, what it means when a value is clearly High or Low, rather than locking you into rigid, concrete numbers.

FULL BLOOD COUNT

1.

FULL BLOOD COUNT (FBC)

FULL
BLOOD

Also known internationally as a [Complete Blood Count \(CBC\)](#).

Think of your blood as a busy highway. The Full Blood Count is a census that counts the different types of vehicles (cells) traveling on that highway. It gives a snapshot of your overall strength, hydration, and immune system.

Key Parameters

Packed Cell Volume (PCV) & Hemoglobin (Hb)

PCV measures the percentage of your blood made up of red blood cells (which carry oxygen), while Hemoglobin is the actual protein inside those cells doing the heavy lifting.

If it's Low: It usually connotes anemia. You might feel chronically tired, dizzy, weak, or experience heart palpitations.

If it's High: It often connotes dehydration (the blood becomes too concentrated because there isn't enough fluid), smoking, or living at a very high altitude.



Caution

If Low

Connotes anemia. Symptoms: tiredness, dizziness, weakness, heart palpitations.



Observation

If High

Connotes dehydration, smoking, or living at high altitude.

WBC Count & Differential

These are your body's defense soldiers. The "differential" breaks down the specific types of soldiers on duty.

Neutrophils **(If High)**: Usually connotes an active bacterial infection (like a severe wound or typhoid) or physical stress/inflammation.

Lymphocytes **(If High)**: Usually connotes a viral infection (like a cold, flu, or certain chronic viral conditions).

Monocytes **(If High)**: Points to chronic, long-term infections or inflammatory disorders.

Eosinophils & Basophils **(If High)**: Strongly connotes allergic reactions (like asthma or skin rashes) or parasitic infections (very common in environments where malaria or worms are prevalent).

Platelets

They are the cells responsible for clotting your blood when you get a cut.

If it's Low: Connotes a risk of easy bruising or prolonged bleeding. It can happen during severe malaria infections or viral illnesses.

If it's High: Connotes inflammation or a bone marrow issue, making the blood more prone to inappropriate clotting.



If Low

Risk of easy bruising or prolonged bleeding. Seen in severe malaria or viral illnesses.



If High

Connotes inflammation or bone marrow issues; risk of inappropriate clotting.

FASTING & RANDOM

2.

**FASTING & RANDOM
BLOOD GLUCOSE
(Blood Sugar)**

BLOOD
GLUCOSE

This test measures the **amount of sugar (glucose)** floating in your bloodstream. Sugar is vital fuel, but too much of it acts like pouring sand into a car engine, it slowly damages your blood vessels over time.

Key Parameters

Blood Glucose Monitoring

Fasting Blood Glucose (FBG): Taken first thing in the morning before you eat or drink anything.

Random Blood Glucose (RBG): Taken at any time of the day, regardless of when you last ate.

If it's Low (Hypoglycemia): Connotes that your body is starved of fuel. Symptoms include shaking, sweating, confusion, blurred vision, or fainting. It can happen if someone skips meals or takes too much diabetes medication.

If it's High (Hyperglycemia): Connotes that your body is struggling to move sugar out of the blood and into the cells. This is a primary indicator for Diabetes or Pre-diabetes. Symptoms include extreme thirst, frequent urination (especially at night), and unexplained weight loss.



Hypoglycemia

If Low

Cells are starved of fuel.

Symptoms: shaking, sweating, confusion, blurred vision, or fainting.



Hyperglycemia

If High

Body is struggling to move sugar into cells.

Symptoms: extreme thirst, frequent urination, weight loss.

ELECTRO
LYTES,
UREA,

3.

**E/U/Cr (Electrolytes,
Urea, and
Creatinine)**

CREAT
NE)

Often called a Kidney Function Test. Your kidneys are your body's ultimate water treatment plant. They filter out waste from everything you eat and drink, balancing your body's water and mineral levels.

Key Parameters:

Renal Function & Electrolytes

Sodium (Na⁺): Controls fluid balance and nerve signaling.

If High or Low: Connotes severe dehydration, fluid overload, or issues with hormone balance. Can cause confusion or muscle weakness.



Caution

If High or Low

Connotes severe dehydration, fluid overload, or hormone imbalance. Symptoms: confusion or muscle weakness.

Potassium (K⁺): Critical for how your heart beats and muscles move.

If High or Low: Extremely dangerous for the heart. It connotes potential kidney struggles or medication side effects, and can cause dangerous irregular heartbeats.



Critical

High or Low (Critical)

Extremely dangerous for the heart. Connotes kidney struggles or medication side effects. Risk: irregular heartbeats.

Urea & Creatinine: Waste products from normal protein and muscle breakdown that the kidneys are supposed to flush away.

If they are High: This is a major red flag connoting that the kidneys are filtering too slowly or are under stress (kidney disease, severe dehydration, or urinary tract blockages).



Red Flag

If High (Red Flag)

Major indicator that kidneys are filtering too slowly or under stress (kidney disease, dehydration, or blockage).

URINALYSIS

4.

URINALYSIS (Urine Test)

URINALYSIS

A urinalysis is a quick, remarkably deep look into your health using just a small cup of urine. It acts like a liquid dashboard indicator for your urinary tract, kidneys, and metabolic health.

Key Parameters:

Urine Analysis

pH & Specific Gravity: Measures how acidic or concentrated your urine is. High concentration usually just means you need to drink more water!

Protein (Proteinuria):

If Present: Protein should ideally be too big to pass through the kidney's filters. If it appears, it connotes kidney inflammation, damage, or high blood pressure stress (or pre-eclampsia in pregnant women).



Caution

If Present

Connotes kidney inflammation, damage, or high blood pressure stress (or pre-eclampsia in pregnant women).

Glucose & Ketones:

If Present: Sugar should not leak into urine. If it does, it heavily connotes that blood sugar is dangerously high (Diabetes).



Diabetes Warning

If Present

Sugar should not leak into urine. If it does, it heavily connotes that blood sugar is dangerously high (Diabetes).

Nitrites & Leukocyte Esterase:

If Present: These are waste products of bacteria and white blood cells. Their presence strongly connotes a Urinary Tract Infection (UTI), which might come with symptoms like burning during urination or lower abdominal pain.



UTI Alert

If Present

Waste products of bacteria and white blood cells. Presence strongly connotes a Urinary Tract Infection (UTI).
Symptoms: burning during urination or lower abdominal pain.

LIPID PROFILE

5.

LIPID PROFILE (Cholesterol Test)

(CHOL
ROL
TEST)

Your lipid profile measures the different types of fats traveling through your blood. While we need some fats to build healthy cells, having too much of the wrong kind can slowly clog your arteries.

Key Parameters:

Lipid Profile

Total Cholesterol: The overall measure of all fats in your blood.

If High: Connotes an elevated risk for cardiovascular issues.



Caution

If High

Elevated cardiovascular risk. Indicates a need for dietary review or increased activity.

Low-Density Lipoprotein (LDL): Known colloquially as "Bad" Cholesterol.

If High: It leaves fatty deposits in your arteries, increasing the risk of high blood pressure, strokes, or heart attacks.



High Risk

If High

It leaves fatty deposits in your arteries, increasing the risk of high blood pressure, strokes, or heart attacks.

High-Density Lipoprotein (HDL): Known as "Good" Cholesterol.

If Low: This is actually a negative sign! You want this value to be high because HDL acts like a vacuum cleaner, clearing bad cholesterol out of your blood vessels.



Critical Insight

If Low: A Negative Sign

This is actually a negative sign! You want this value to be high because HDL acts like a vacuum cleaner, clearing bad cholesterol out of your blood vessels.

Triglycerides: Another type of fat used for stored energy.

If High: Connotes a lifestyle with excess calorie intake or alcohol use, which hardens the arteries over time.



Lifestyle Indicator

If High

Connotes a lifestyle with excess calorie intake or alcohol use, which hardens the arteries over time.

**WANT TO
STOP
GUESSING
WHAT YOUR
RESULTS
MEAN?**



Once [Clinsight launches](#), you will never have to copy and paste confusing terms into Google again. Get plain-English clarity within minutes. No medical jargon. No endless Google panic spirals. Just the exact insights you need to walk into your next doctor's appointment with confidence

[Keep an eye on your email inbox](#), we will text and email you your Clinsight app download link the second we launch.

MEDICAL DISCLAIMER

This guide is for educational purposes only and does not substitute for professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment. Medications should never be prescribed or altered based on a self-reading of this guide. Always discuss your results directly with a qualified healthcare provider.

[Join the Clinsight WhatsApp Group Today](#) To Be Among The First Beta Testers of Our App

WhatsApp link (<https://chat.whatsapp.com/CMZOtpPcH6z7Clyle3L66L>)



REFERENCES FOR FURTHER READING

If you wish to read deeper into these parameters, you can explore these online resources:

[American Society of Hematology \(Blood Basics\)](#)

[Kidney Function Parameters](#)

<https://www.mayoclinic.org/diseases-conditions/heart-disease/in-depth/heart-disease/art-20049357>

<https://newsnetwork.mayoclinic.org/discussion/mayo-clinic-minute-5-things-your-blood-can-tell-you-about-your-health/>